

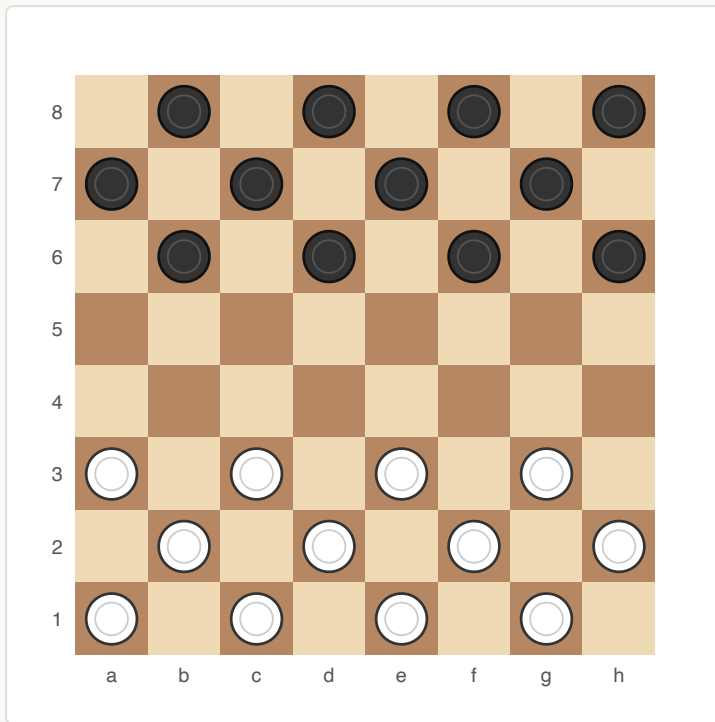
DRAUGHTS · VARIANT 1 OF 6

English Draughts

8×8 BOARD	2 PLAYERS
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ENGLISH DRAUGHTS

The most widely known form of draughts, and the simplest to learn. Known as “Checkers” in North America. Developed in Europe around 1100 CE, probably in southern France, by adapting the older game of Alquerque to a chessboard.



English Draughts — starting position

SETUP

Board: 8×8 checkered board (64 squares, only 32 dark squares used). Orient the board so each player has a dark corner square on their left.

Pieces: 12 men per player in two distinct colours. Place all 12 on the dark squares of the three rows closest to you. The two central rows remain empty.

First move: The player with darker pieces moves first.

RULES

- ♦ **Men movement:** Men move diagonally forward only, one square at a time, to an unoccupied dark square. Men cannot move backwards or sideways.
- ♦ **Capturing:** A man captures by jumping diagonally forward over an adjacent opponent piece to the vacant square beyond. The captured piece is removed from the board.
- ♦ **Mandatory capture:** If a capture is available, it must be taken.
- ♦ **Multiple captures:** If after a jump another capture is immediately available, the same piece must continue jumping. A multi-capture sequence must be completed in full.
- ♦ **Free choice:** If multiple capture options exist on a turn, the player may freely choose which one to take (no majority rule in English Draughts).

KING PROMOTION

When a man reaches the opponent's back row (the row furthest from where it started), it is promoted to a King. A second piece is placed on top to mark it.

- ♦ Kings move diagonally in any direction (forward or backward), one square at a time.
- ♦ Kings capture diagonally in any direction by jumping over an adjacent opponent piece.
- ♦ If a man reaches the back row during a multi-capture sequence, it is promoted immediately and the sequence ends there (the new King cannot continue capturing on the same turn).

WINNING

A player wins when their opponent has no legal move available:

- ♦ All opponent pieces have been captured, or
- ♦ All remaining opponent pieces are completely blocked from moving.

DRAWS

The game is a draw when:

- ♦ Both players agree to a draw.
- ♦ The same position occurs three times with the same player to move.
- ♦ 40 consecutive moves pass with no capture and no man reaching the King row.
- ♦ Neither player can force a win (e.g. one King vs one King).

STRATEGY

Control the centre early. Keep a solid back row as long as possible to deny your opponent king promotions. In the endgame, a king has enormous advantage over trapped men. Sacrifice pieces to force your opponent into positions where their remaining pieces block each other.

ATTRIBUTION

English Draughts. Public domain. Rules standardised by the World Draughts Federation (FMJD) and the English Draughts Association.

DRAUGHTS · VARIANT 2 OF 6

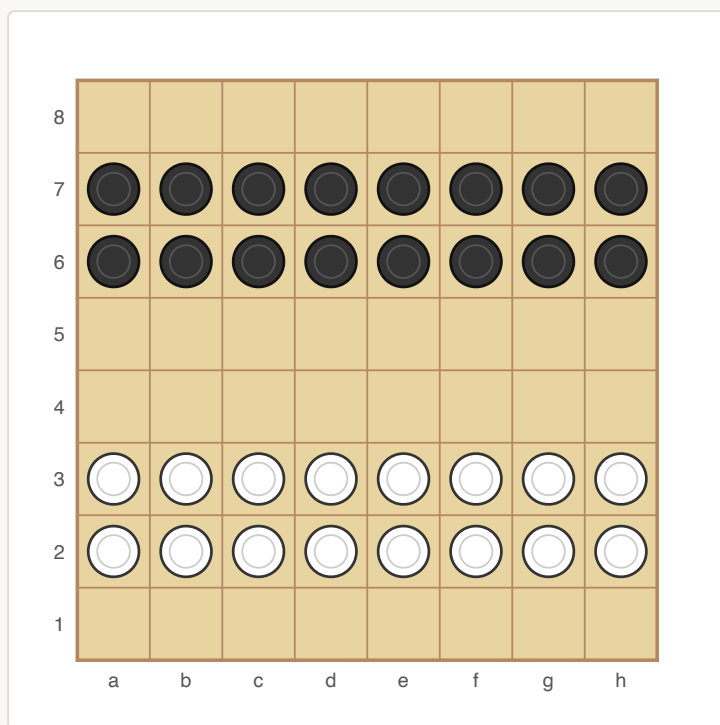
Turkish Draughts

8×8
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

TURKISH DRAUGHTS

Orthogonal movement on an 8x8 board replaces the diagonal play of standard draughts. Mandatory captures, majority rule, and immediate removal create sharp tactical puzzles. World Championships held since 2014.



Turkish Draughts — starting position

SETUP

Board: 8x8 mono-coloured board (not checkered). All 64 squares are used.

Pieces: Each player begins with 16 men arranged in two rows: White on rows 2 and 3, Black on rows 6 and 7. The back rows (1 and 8) are left vacant.

First move: White moves first.

RULES

- ♦ **Men movement:** Men move orthogonally (straight forwards or sideways) by one square. Men cannot move backwards. Men cannot move diagonally.
- ♦ **Capturing:** Captures are made by jumping over an adjacent opponent piece to a vacant square beyond. Jumping is mandatory. Men can only capture forwards or sideways, never backwards or diagonally.
- ♦ **Majority rule:** When multiple capture sequences are available, the player must choose the sequence that captures the most pieces. If two or more sequences capture the same number, the player may freely choose. No distinction between Kings and men when counting.
- ♦ **Immediate removal:** Captured pieces are removed from the board immediately after being jumped. A square vacated by an earlier capture in the same sequence becomes available for the capturing piece to pass through.
- ♦ **King promotion:** When a man reaches the opponent's back row, it is promoted to a King.
- ♦ **King movement:** Kings move any number of empty squares orthogonally in all four directions (forwards, backwards, sideways).
- ♦ **King capture:** Kings capture by jumping over a single opponent piece that is any number of empty squares away, landing on any open square beyond the captured piece along the same line.
- ♦ **King turn restriction:** During a multi-capture sequence, a King cannot turn 180 degrees between two consecutive captures. It must change direction (90 degrees) or continue forward.

WIN CONDITION

A player wins when their opponent has no legal move available: either all pieces captured or all pieces blocked.

DRAWS

A King versus a single man results in a draw.

ATTRIBUTION

Traditional variant. Public domain. Source: Wikipedia (CC-BY-SA).

DRAUGHTS · VARIANT 3 OF 6

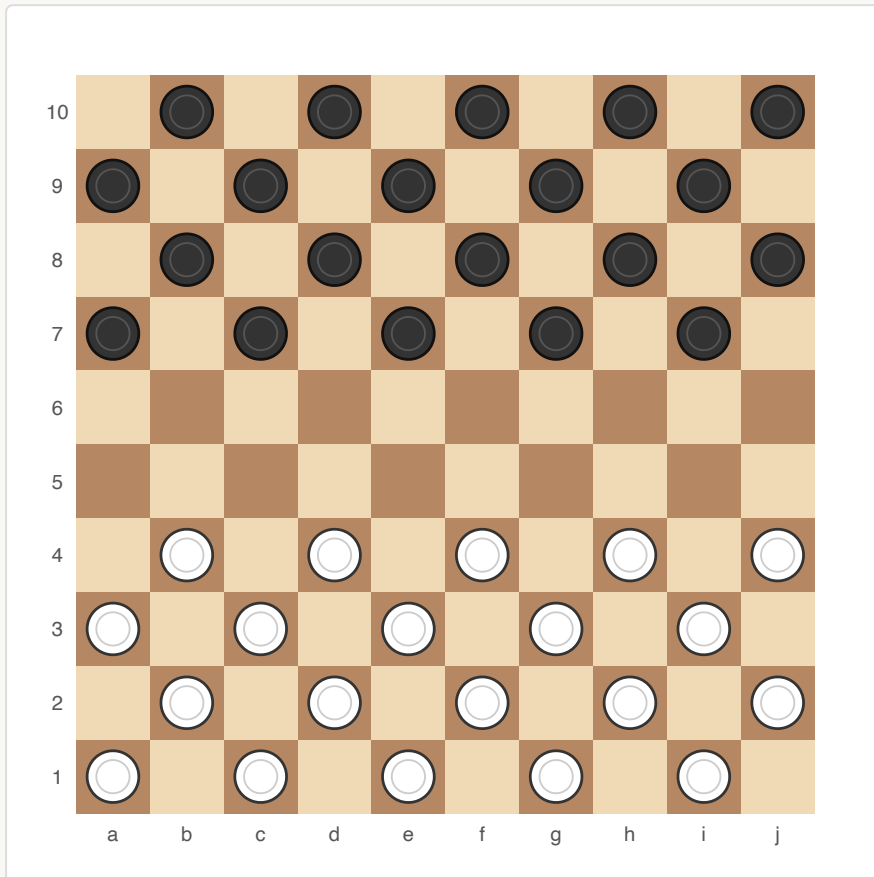
International Draughts

10×10
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

INTERNATIONAL DRAUGHTS

The competitive standard for tournament play worldwide. Evolved independently from Alquerque in the Netherlands around 1550, expanding to a 10×10 board with flying kings and strict capture priority rules. Historically called “Polish Draughts” (a misnomer from Dutch convention, not Polish origin). Governed by the World Draughts Federation (FMJD).



International Draughts — starting position

SETUP

Board: 10×10 checkered board. Only the 50 dark squares are used. Orient the board so the long diagonal runs from each player's lower-left to upper-right.

Pieces: 20 men per player. Place all 20 on the dark squares of your four nearest rows. The two central rows remain empty.

First move: White moves first.

RULES

- ♦ **Men movement:** Men move diagonally forward only, one square at a time, to an unoccupied dark square.
- ♦ **Men capture:** Men capture by jumping diagonally over an adjacent opponent piece to the vacant square beyond. Men can capture both forwards and backwards (unlike English Draughts).
- ♦ **Mandatory capture:** If any capture is available, it must be taken, even if disadvantageous.
- ♦ **Majority rule:** When multiple capture sequences are available, the player must choose the piece and path that captures the maximum number of pieces. If tied, the player may freely choose.
- ♦ **Delayed removal:** Captured pieces remain on the board until the entire multi-jump sequence is complete, then all are removed simultaneously. A jumped piece cannot be jumped again in the same sequence, but it still physically occupies its square during the turn.
- ♦ **No re-jumping:** A piece cannot jump over the same opponent piece twice in one sequence.

KING PROMOTION

When a man ends its turn on the opponent's back row, it is promoted to a King (flying king).

- ♦ **Flying kings:** Kings move any number of unoccupied squares diagonally in any direction.
- ♦ **King capture:** Kings capture by jumping over a single opponent piece that is any number of empty squares away along a diagonal, landing on any open square beyond the captured piece along the same line.
- ♦ **No mid-sequence promotion:** If a man passes through the opponent's back row during a multi-jump sequence (without stopping there), it is NOT promoted. Promotion only occurs when the piece ends its turn on the back row.

WINNING

A player wins when their opponent has no legal move available: all pieces captured or all pieces blocked.

DRAWS

The game is a draw when:

- ♦ Both players agree.
- ♦ The same position occurs three times with the same player to move.
- ♦ 25 consecutive king moves pass with no capture and no man movement.
- ♦ Neither player can force a win.

STRATEGY

The 10x10 board rewards long-range planning. Flying kings dominate the endgame, so preventing your opponent's promotion while securing your own is critical. The majority capture rule creates combination opportunities: sacrifice pieces to force your opponent into a capture sequence that leaves them exposed.

ATTRIBUTION

Traditional variant. Public domain. Rules standardised by the World Draughts Federation (FMJD). Source: FMJD Official Rules, Wikipedia (CC-BY-SA).

DRAUGHTS · VARIANT 4 OF 6

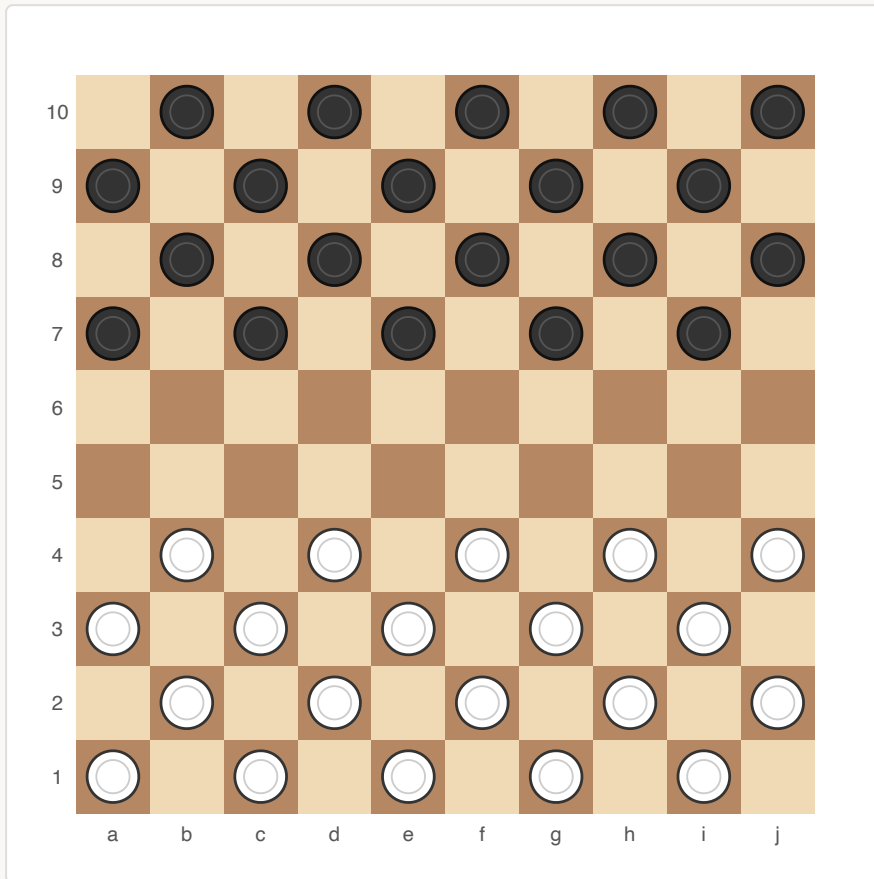
Frisian Draughts

10×10
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

FRISIAN DRAUGHTS

International Draughts with one radical addition: pieces can capture orthogonally (horizontally and vertically) as well as diagonally. This expands capture directions from 4 to 8, creating far more tactical combinations. Originating in Friesland (Netherlands), it has its own World Championship (Frysk Dammjen) recognised by the World Draughts Federation.



Frisian Draughts — starting position

SETUP

Identical to International Draughts. 10×10 checkered board, 20 men per player on the dark squares of their four nearest rows.

First move: White moves first.

RULES

All International Draughts rules apply, with the following changes:

- ♦ **8-direction capture:** Both men and kings can capture in all 8 directions: diagonal (forward and backward) plus orthogonal (up, down, left, right). This is the defining feature of Frisian Draughts.
- ♦ **Movement unchanged:** Non-capturing moves remain diagonal only. Men move diagonally forward one square. Kings fly diagonally any number of squares. Orthogonal movement is only available when capturing.
- ♦ **Men capture backwards:** Men capture in all 8 directions, including backward diagonal and backward orthogonal.
- ♦ **Majority rule:** Must take the sequence that captures the most pieces (highest “shot value”).
- ♦ **King preference:** If both a man and a king have capture sequences of equal value, the king must make the capture.
- ♦ **3-move king limit:** A king may make only 3 consecutive non-capturing moves. After 3, the player must move a man or make a capture. If a player has only kings remaining, this restriction is lifted.
- ♦ **King distance capture:** Kings capture at distance in any of the 8 directions (not just diagonally), jumping over a single opponent piece with empty space beyond.
- ♦ **Delayed removal:** Captured pieces remain on the board until the entire multi-jump sequence completes (same as International).

WINNING

A player wins when their opponent has no legal move available: all pieces captured or all pieces blocked.

DRAWS

Same draw conditions as International Draughts.

STRATEGY

The orthogonal capture dimension creates combinations invisible in standard International play. Pieces that would be safe on the diagonal are now vulnerable to horizontal and vertical jumps. The 3-move king limit prevents drawn-out endgames with aimless king manoeuvring, forcing decisive action. The king preference rule means your kings are forced into capture exchanges even when a man could take the same chain at less cost.

ATTRIBUTION

Traditional variant from Friesland, Netherlands. Public domain. Recognised by the World Draughts Federation (FMJD). Source: Wikipedia (CC-BY-SA).

DRAUGHTS · VARIANT 5 OF 6

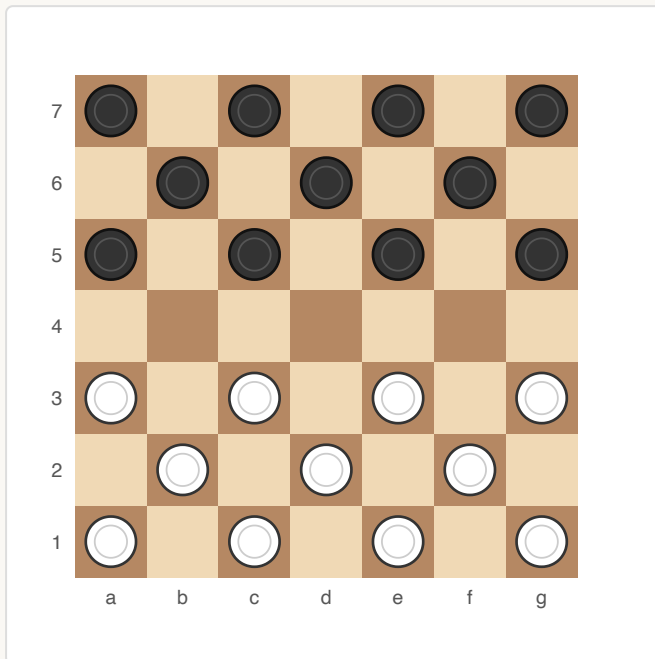
Lasca

7×7
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

LASCA

Emanuel Lasker's 1911 column checkers. Captured pieces stack beneath the captor instead of leaving the board. All 22 pieces stay in play for the entire game. Ownership shifts as columns change hands.



Lasca — starting position

SETUP

Board: 7x7 board using only the 25 diagonal squares (like draughts).

Pieces: Each player starts with 11 pieces. White occupies all 11 squares on rows 1, 2, and 3. Black occupies all 11 squares on rows 5, 6, and 7. The three middle-row squares (row 4) start empty.

First move: White moves first.

RULES

- ♦ **Soldiers:** Unpromoted pieces (soldiers) move and capture diagonally forward only, one square at a time.
- ♦ **Officers:** When a soldier reaches the opponent's back row, it is promoted to an officer. Officers move and capture diagonally in any direction, one square at a time.
- ♦ **Column formation:** When a piece jumps an opponent's piece, the captured piece is placed underneath the capturing piece, forming a column. A column is controlled by the player whose piece is on top.
- ♦ **Column movement:** A column moves according to its top piece's rank: a soldier-led column moves forward only; an officer-led column moves in any direction.
- ♦ **Capturing a column:** When you jump over a column, you take only the top piece. That top piece goes under your jumping piece or column. The remaining column stays in place, now controlled by whatever piece is next from the top. Capturing an opponent's column can liberate your own buried pieces.
- ♦ **Multi-jump:** Multi-jumps are mandatory if available. If multiple capture sequences exist, the player has free choice (no majority rule). A piece may not jump the same column twice in one sequence.
- ♦ **Promotion during multi-jump:** If a soldier reaches the back row during a multi-jump, the sequence ends there and the soldier is promoted. If an officer-led column passes through the promotion row, the sequence continues.
- ♦ **The 22-piece invariant:** Pieces are never removed from the game. All 22 pieces remain on the board at all times, either individually or stacked within columns.
- ♦ **Officer retention:** Officers retain their rank permanently, even when buried inside a column. When liberated, they immediately function as officers again.
- ♦ **Mandatory capture:** Capturing is compulsory. If a capture is available, it must be taken.

WIN CONDITION

A player wins when their opponent cannot make any legal move: either all opponent pieces are buried inside columns controlled by the other player, or all opponent-controlled pieces are blocked.

STRATEGY

Because pieces are never eliminated, the game is about control rather than attrition. Building tall columns creates power but also concentrates risk. Liberating buried officers can swing the game dramatically.

ATTRIBUTION

Invented by Emanuel Lasker (World Chess Champion), 1911. Public domain. Source: Wikipedia + Lasker 1911 (CC-BY-SA).

DRAUGHTS · VARIANT 6 OF 6

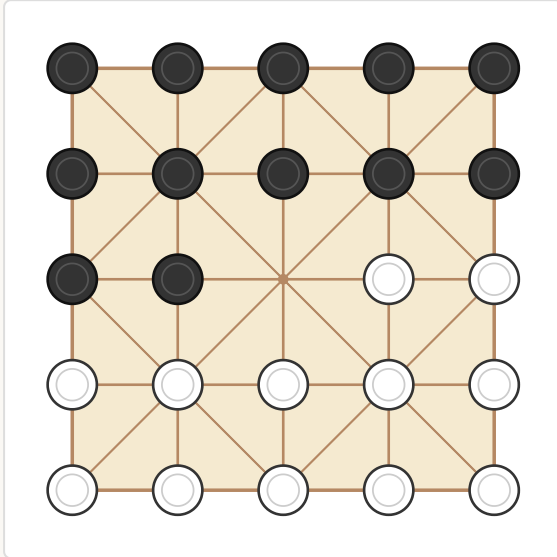
Alquerque

5×5
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

ALQUERQUE

The common ancestor of all draughts variants. First documented by Abu al-Faraj al-Isfahani in the 10th century, with detailed rules recorded in Alfonso X's Libro de los Juegos (1283, Spain). Played on a 5×5 grid of intersecting lines rather than on squares, with movement along the connections.



Alquerque — starting position

SETUP

Board: 5×5 grid of 25 intersection points, connected by orthogonal lines (horizontal and vertical) and diagonal lines on alternating 2×2 squares. Not all points have diagonal connections: some intersections have 8 lines leading from them, others only 4.

Pieces: 12 per player (24 total on a 25-point board). Each player occupies their two nearest rows (10 pieces) plus the two points on their side of the middle row. The centre point starts empty.

First move: Players agree or draw lots.

RULES

- ♦ **Movement:** Pieces move one point along any connected line (orthogonal or diagonal) to an adjacent empty point. Movement is allowed in any direction, including backwards.
- ♦ **Capture:** A piece captures by jumping over an adjacent opponent piece along a connected line to the empty point directly beyond. The captured piece is removed.
- ♦ **Mandatory capture:** Captures are compulsory. If a capture is available, it must be taken.
- ♦ **Multiple captures:** If after a jump another capture is immediately available along any connected line, the piece must continue jumping. A multi-capture sequence must be completed in full.
- ♦ **No promotion:** There is no king or officer rank. All pieces move identically throughout the game.
- ♦ **Line constraint:** Movement and capture can only occur along lines drawn on the board. A diagonal move is only legal at intersections connected by a diagonal line.

WINNING

A player wins when their opponent has no legal move: all pieces captured or all remaining pieces blocked.

HISTORICAL NOTE

The rules above follow the Alfonso X source (1283). R.C. Bell's widely cited modern reconstruction (1960s) adds restrictions: no backward movement for men, and no revisiting a previously occupied point in the same turn. Both versions are historically attested. The unrestricted version better represents the original game from which draughts evolved.

STRATEGY

With no promotion and symmetric piece capabilities, position is everything. The centre point controls the most lines and is the strongest position on the board. Force your opponent into corners where their pieces have fewer connections and fewer escape routes.

ATTRIBUTION

Traditional game. Public domain. Documented in Libro de los Juegos (Alfonso X, 1283). Source: Wikipedia (CC-BY-SA), Murray's A History of Board Games Other Than Chess (1952).